

CBSE / NCERT | CLASS X | 2026-27 PRACTICE EDITION

English

Assertion and Reason

First Flight | Footprints Without Feet

31 chapters | 62 questions | answer key with explanations

How to answer

Judge Assertion (A) and Reason (R) separately, then decide whether R explains A.

A	Both A and R are true, and R explains A.
B	Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A.
C	A is true, but R is false.
D	A is false, but R is true.

The chapter set includes textbook extension chapters too. Status labels distinguish current board content, formative/project/map-only items and chapters not listed in the cited annual syllabus.

01. First Flight - A Letter to God

Current literature course

Q1

Assertion (A): Lencho believed the hailstorm had destroyed his crop.

Reason (R): The falling hail covered the fields and left them looking as if they were salted.

Q2

Assertion (A): Lencho called the post office workers crooks after receiving less money than he requested.

Reason (R): He had asked God for one hundred pesos but received only seventy.

02. First Flight - Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom

Current literature course

Q1

Assertion (A): Mandela says freedom is indivisible.

Reason (R): The oppressor is also deprived of humanity by oppression.

Q2

Assertion (A): Mandela's inauguration marked the end of apartheid rule.

Reason (R): South Africa's first democratic election had elected a government representing all citizens.

03. First Flight - Two Stories About Flying

Current literature course

Q1

Assertion (A): The young seagull finally flew after his fear gave way to hunger.

Reason (R): His mother tempted him with food held just beyond his reach.

Q2

Assertion (A): The pilot in 'The Black Aeroplane' guides the narrator through the storm.

Reason (R): The narrator later cannot find another plane or pilot in the control tower's account.

04. First Flight - From the Diary of Anne Frank

Current literature course

Q1

Assertion (A): Anne feels lonely even though she has family and acquaintances around her.

Reason (R): She wants a true friend with whom she can share her innermost thoughts.

Q2**Assertion (A):** Anne names her diary Kitty and treats it like a friend.**Reason (R):** Writing lets her express feelings she does not share freely with others.

05. First Flight - The Hundred Dresses I

Older textbook chapter; not in the 2025-26 board literature list

Q1**Assertion (A):** Wanda's classmates repeatedly tease her about her claim of owning a hundred dresses.**Reason (R):** Wanda wears the same faded dress to school each day.**Q2****Assertion (A):** Maddie feels uneasy when Peggy makes fun of Wanda.**Reason (R):** Maddie fears that she may be the next target because she is also poor.

06. First Flight - The Hundred Dresses II

Older textbook chapter; not in the 2025-26 board literature list

Q1**Assertion (A):** Wanda's letter makes Peggy and Maddie reconsider their treatment of her.**Reason (R):** Wanda sends drawings to the girls and says they may keep them.**Q2****Assertion (A):** Maddie resolves to speak up when someone is bullied.**Reason (R):** She regrets not having defended Wanda earlier.

07. First Flight - Glimpses of India

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** The traditional baker remains an important part of Goan village life.**Reason (R):** Bread is used in everyday routines and celebrations described in the chapter.**Q2****Assertion (A):** Coorg is described as a place with distinctive landscapes and cultural traditions.**Reason (R):** The chapter also presents tea gardens and tea-making traditions in Assam.

08. First Flight - Mijbil the Otter

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** Mijbil enjoys playing with water.**Reason (R):** Otters are adapted to an aquatic way of life.**Q2****Assertion (A):** Mijbil quickly becomes a curious and playful companion.**Reason (R):** Maxwell takes him from Iraq to London.

09. First Flight - Madam Rides the Bus

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** Valli carefully plans her first bus journey by herself.**Reason (R):** She learns the fare, timing and route by listening to conversations.**Q2****Assertion (A):** The sight of the dead cow changes Valli's mood on the return trip.**Reason (R):** Earlier, she had laughed at the same cow running beside the bus.

10. First Flight - The Sermon at Benares

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** Kisa Gotami begins to understand that death comes to every family.**Reason (R):** She cannot find a household untouched by death.**Q2****Assertion (A):** The Buddha asks Kisa Gotami to bring mustard seeds from a house with no bereavement.**Reason (R):** The task helps her discover that no family is free from loss.

11. First Flight - The Proposal

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** Lomov and Natalya repeatedly argue during a marriage proposal.**Reason (R):** They quarrel about Oxen Meadows and whose dog is better.**Q2****Assertion (A):** The play uses exaggerated arguments for comic effect.**Reason (R):** The characters turn trivial matters into serious disputes.

12. First Flight Poem - Dust of Snow

Current literature course

Q1

Assertion (A): A small moment in nature changes the speaker's gloomy mood.

Reason (R): The crow's movement shakes snow from a hemlock tree onto him.

Q2

Assertion (A): The poem suggests that an ordinary event can alter a person's outlook.

Reason (R): The speaker says part of his day was saved from regret.

13. First Flight Poem - Fire and Ice

Current literature course

Q1

Assertion (A): The poem presents desire and hatred as forces capable of destruction.

Reason (R): Fire and ice are used as images for destructive human emotions.

Q2

Assertion (A): The speaker considers only fire capable of ending the world.

Reason (R): He also says ice would suffice if the world had to perish twice.

14. First Flight Poem - A Tiger in the Zoo

Current literature course

Q1

Assertion (A): The caged tiger is unable to live with the freedom of a wild tiger.

Reason (R): The cage prevents it from roaming and hunting in its natural habitat.

Q2

Assertion (A): The poem contrasts the tiger's imagined natural power with its silent captivity.

Reason (R): The caged tiger moves in a limited space behind bars.

15. First Flight Poem - How to Tell Wild Animals

Current literature course

Q1

Assertion (A): The poem uses humorous exaggeration to describe dangerous encounters with wild animals.

Reason (R): Its playful rhymes make the descriptions sound comic.

Q2**Assertion (A):** The poem is a serious safety manual for identifying animals at close range.**Reason (R):** Its comic advice often describes being attacked as the way to identify an animal.

16. First Flight Poem - The Ball Poem

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** The boy must learn to face loss rather than expect every lost possession to return.**Reason (R):** The lost ball cannot simply be replaced in a way that removes the experience of loss.**Q2****Assertion (A):** The ball is valuable only because of its price.**Reason (R):** The boy's reaction shows that it carries personal memories and feeling.

17. First Flight Poem - Amanda!

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** Amanda imagines worlds where she can be free from constant instructions.**Reason (R):** She pictures herself as a mermaid, an orphan and Rapunzel.**Q2****Assertion (A):** The poem presents Amanda as completely unconcerned about how adults see her.**Reason (R):** The repeated commands show that adults are monitoring her behaviour.

18. First Flight Poem - Animals

Older textbook poem; not in the 2025-26 board literature list

Q1**Assertion (A):** The speaker admires animals for their calmness and lack of complaint.**Reason (R):** He contrasts them with human beings who worry about possessions and status.**Q2****Assertion (A):** The poem claims that animals are driven by guilt over past actions.**Reason (R):** The speaker says animals do not lie awake regretting their sins.

19. First Flight Poem - The Trees

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** The trees are shown moving out of the house toward the forest.**Reason (R):** The poem personifies their movement as a release into the natural world.**Q2****Assertion (A):** The poem treats the house as the natural home of the trees.**Reason (R):** The trees strain to move out toward the forest.

20. First Flight Poem - Fog

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** The fog is compared to a cat.**Reason (R):** It arrives quietly, sits briefly and then moves on.**Q2****Assertion (A):** The poem describes fog as a loud and sudden storm.**Reason (R):** The fog comes on little cat feet.

21. First Flight Poem - The Tale of Custard the Dragon

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** Custard proves brave when the pirate threatens the household.**Reason (R):** He attacks the pirate while the others hide or flee.**Q2****Assertion (A):** The poem's humour comes partly from the contrast between boasting and action.**Reason (R):** The supposedly timid dragon is the one who faces the danger.

22. First Flight Poem - For Anne Gregory

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** The poem questions whether human love is based only on inner qualities.**Reason (R):** The speaker points to Anne's yellow hair as a feature that attracts people.**Q2****Assertion (A):** The poem says that human beings always see and love a person's inner self.**Reason (R):** It suggests that only God can love a person for the self within.

23. Footprints Without Feet - A Triumph of Surgery

Current literature course

Q1

Assertion (A): Tricki's recovery is linked to exercise and a controlled diet.

Reason (R): At the surgery, he receives companionship and regular activity rather than rich treats.

Q2

Assertion (A): Mrs Pumphrey's excessive care contributes to Tricki's poor condition.

Reason (R): She gives him rich food and little exercise.

24. Footprints Without Feet - The Thief's Story

Current literature course

Q1

Assertion (A): Anil's trust helps Hari Singh choose to return the stolen money.

Reason (R): Anil offers him food, shelter and a chance to learn.

Q2

Assertion (A): Hari Singh is shown as incapable of changing his behaviour.

Reason (R): He returns after taking the money and resolves to learn from Anil.

25. Footprints Without Feet - The Midnight Visitor

Current literature course

Q1

Assertion (A): Ausable defeats Max through quick thinking rather than physical strength.

Reason (R): He invents a story about a balcony and a police visit.

Q2

Assertion (A): Fowler expects a secret agent to look glamorous and dramatic.

Reason (R): Ausable appears ordinary and is described as very overweight.

26. Footprints Without Feet - A Question of Trust

Current literature course

Q1

Assertion (A): Horace Danby is still a thief even though he steals only once a year.

Reason (R): He breaks into houses to obtain money for his collection of rare books.

Q2**Assertion (A):** The woman in red tricks Horace by pretending to be the owner of the house.**Reason (R):** Horace trusts her and removes his gloves while opening the safe.

27. Footprints Without Feet - Footprints without Feet

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** Griffin's scientific discovery does not make him a responsible person.**Reason (R):** He uses invisibility to steal, threaten and damage property.**Q2****Assertion (A):** Griffin can remain unnoticed in every situation because he is invisible.**Reason (R):** His bare footprints can still be seen in the mud.

28. Footprints Without Feet - The Making of a Scientist

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** Richard Ebright's curiosity and sustained work contribute to his success.**Reason (R):** His mother encourages him and provides books and opportunities to learn.**Q2****Assertion (A):** Ebright's achievements come from memorising facts without investigation.**Reason (R):** He performs experiments and learns to ask better scientific questions.

29. Footprints Without Feet - The Necklace

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** Mathilde and her husband spend years repaying the cost of a necklace that was imitation jewellery.**Reason (R):** Madame Forestier later reveals that the original necklace was not valuable.**Q2****Assertion (A):** Mathilde's desire for a life of luxury shapes her choices.**Reason (R):** She borrows a necklace because she wants to appear wealthy at the party.

30. Footprints Without Feet - Bholi

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** Bholi gains confidence partly because her teacher treats her with patience.**Reason (R):** The teacher encourages her to speak and promises that she will learn.**Q2****Assertion (A):** Bholi agrees to marry Bishamber after he demands money.**Reason (R):** She refuses the marriage when she sees his greed and disrespect.

31. Footprints Without Feet - The Book That Saved the Earth

Current literature course

Q1**Assertion (A):** Think-Tank orders the Martians to retreat because he misunderstands a nursery rhyme book.**Reason (R):** He interprets the rhymes as evidence that Earthlings possess terrifying power.**Q2****Assertion (A):** The play uses misunderstanding to create comedy.**Reason (R):** Think-Tank treats ordinary rhymes as serious military intelligence.

Answer key and explanations

01. First Flight - A Letter to God

Q1 - A. The visible damage explains his belief that the crop was lost.

Q2 - A. The shortfall led him to suspect the people who handled the letter.

02. First Flight - Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom

Q1 - A. The passage links the freedom of the oppressed with the humanity of the oppressor.

Q2 - A. The inclusive election made the inauguration a landmark transition.

03. First Flight - Two Stories About Flying

Q1 - A. The attempt to reach food drew him into the first flight.

Q2 - B. Both details are true in the story, but the mystery does not explain the guidance.

04. First Flight - From the Diary of Anne Frank

Q1 - A. Her need for a trusted confidante explains the loneliness she describes.

Q2 - A. The diary becomes a safe confidante for private thoughts.

05. First Flight - The Hundred Dresses I

Q1 - B. Both details are true, but her repeated dress does not itself explain the classmates' teasing.

Q2 - A. Her fear of becoming a target explains her discomfort and silence.

06. First Flight - The Hundred Dresses II

Q1 - A. Her generous response prompts them to reflect on their earlier behaviour.

Q2 - A. Her regret motivates the promise to act differently in future.

07. First Flight - Glimpses of India

Q1 - A. Its place in daily and festive life sustains the baker's role.

Q2 - B. Both descriptions are true, but Assam's tea does not explain Coorg's character.

08. First Flight - Mijbil the Otter

Q1 - A. His attraction to water fits the habits of an aquatic mammal.

Q2 - B. Both are true, but the journey does not explain Mijbil's playful nature.

09. First Flight - Madam Rides the Bus

Q1 - A. Gathering details helps her plan the trip independently.

Q2 - A. The contrast between the lively cow and its death makes the return ride sobering.

10. First Flight - The Sermon at Benares

Q1 - A. Her search teaches her that bereavement is universal.

Q2 - A. The impossible condition leads her to the lesson about shared mortality.

11. First Flight - The Proposal

Q1 - A. Their petty disputes interrupt the proposal and create the comedy.

Q2 - A. The disproportion between the issues and their reactions creates humour.

12. First Flight Poem - Dust of Snow

Q1 - A. That brief natural event changes how he views the day.

Q2 - A. The saved portion of the day shows a change in outlook.

13. First Flight Poem - Fire and Ice

Q1 - A. The images connect human feelings with the world's possible end.

Q2 - D. The assertion is false; the reason is true.

14. First Flight Poem - A Tiger in the Zoo

Q1 - A. The restrictions of captivity explain the contrast with a free tiger.

Q2 - A. The confined movement makes the loss of freedom visible.

15. First Flight Poem - How to Tell Wild Animals

Q1 - B. Both are true, but the rhyme is a device rather than the cause of the dangerous encounters.

Q2 - D. The assertion is false; the reason is true.

16. First Flight Poem - The Ball Poem

Q1 - A. The speaker treats the loss as an important lesson in responsibility and acceptance.

Q2 - D. The assertion is false; the reason is true.

17. First Flight Poem - Amanda!

Q1 - A. These imagined identities express her wish for freedom and solitude.

Q2 - D. The assertion is false; the reason is true.

18. First Flight Poem - Animals

Q1 - A. The contrast explains the speaker's admiration for animals.

Q2 - D. The assertion is false; the reason is true.

19. First Flight Poem - The Trees

Q1 - A. The personification presents the trees as reclaiming their place outside.

Q2 - D. The assertion is false; the reason is true.

20. First Flight Poem - Fog

Q1 - A. The cat image captures the fog's silent arrival and departure.

Q2 - D. The assertion is false; the reason is true.

21. First Flight Poem - The Tale of Custard the Dragon

Q1 - A. His action demonstrates the courage that others had only claimed.

Q2 - A. The reversal of expected roles creates comic surprise.

22. First Flight Poem - For Anne Gregory

Q1 - A. The discussion of her hair raises the question of appearance-based love.

Q2 - D. The assertion is false; the reason is true.

23. Footprints Without Feet - A Triumph of Surgery

Q1 - A. The changed routine restores his health.

Q2 - A. Overfeeding and inactivity explain his illness.

24. Footprints Without Feet - The Thief's Story

Q1 - A. Kindness and the prospect of education make Hari reconsider his choice.

Q2 - D. The assertion is false; the reason is true.

25. Footprints Without Feet - The Midnight Visitor

Q1 - A. The invented details manipulate Max into making a fatal mistake.

Q2 - B. Both are true, but Ausable's appearance does not explain Fowler's expectation.

26. Footprints Without Feet - A Question of Trust

Q1 - A. A sympathetic motive does not change the unlawful act.

Q2 - A. His trust and bare fingerprints help her frame him.

27. Footprints Without Feet - Footprints without Feet

Q1 - A. His actions show that scientific ability is not matched by ethical restraint.

Q2 - D. The assertion is false; the reason is true.

28. Footprints Without Feet - The Making of a Scientist

Q1 - A. Support and his own effort nurture his scientific development.

Q2 - D. The assertion is false; the reason is true.

29. Footprints Without Feet - The Necklace

Q1 - B. Both statements are true; the revelation exposes the irony but did not cause the years of repayment.

Q2 - A. Her wish to appear rich leads directly to borrowing the necklace.

30. Footprints Without Feet - Bholi

Q1 - A. Supportive teaching helps Bholi overcome fear and hesitation.

Q2 - D. The assertion is false; the reason is true.

31. Footprints Without Feet - The Book That Saved the Earth

Q1 - A. His mistaken reading creates the fear that drives the retreat.

Q2 - A. The gap between the harmless text and his dramatic interpretation is comic.

Scope and sources

The chapter set includes textbook extension chapters too. Status labels distinguish current board content, formative/project/map-only items and chapters not listed in the cited annual syllabus.

Question text in this workbook is original practice material. Chapter labels and scope notes are provided for navigation; check your school's current list before using extension chapters for exam revision.

CBSE Class X English Language and Literature curriculum 2025-26

https://cbseacademic.nic.in/web_material/CurriculumMain26/Sec/English_LL_2025-26.pdf

CBSE curriculum portal

https://cbseacademic.nic.in/curriculum_2027.html

OneShotMastery